Valentin Nikolaev

Tech Lead / Backend Engineer

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LinkedIn | GitHub

Summary

Technical lead and backend engineer with more than fifteen years of experience delivering PHP and Go services across production platforms. I have guided teams from planning through release, made backend architecture decisions, and handled reliability and security work in systems where changes need careful rollout. My recent work includes privacy-sensitive communications, event-driven services and PHP integrations. I work closely with product, frontend and infrastructure colleagues to clarify integration boundaries, plan releases and support systems after deployment.

Skills

Backend: PHP, Go, Laravel, Symfony, REST APIs, MySQL, PostgreSQL.

Architecture and operations: Event-driven systems, RabbitMQ, AWS, Kubernetes, CI/CD, Prometheus.

Security and delivery: PCI DSS development, GDPR implementation, technical leadership, code reviews.

Experience

Simple.life (Simple App) — Software Developer | November 2023 – 2026

- Designed the backend architecture for privacy-sensitive outbound calling and carried its security decisions through formal review.
- Built lawful-calling controls around customer time zones, opt-outs and call outcomes, keeping contact history in the existing helpdesk ticket.
- Built a vendor-neutral helpdesk gateway connecting Intercom and Zendesk, enabling the first B2B demo of the support AI product.
- Delivered a self-service GDPR data-export workflow and reworked account-deletion coordination across services.
- Built support-agent actions and evaluation data flows that expanded production automation and made agent behaviour easier to assess.

Technologies: Go, AWS, Amazon Connect, Intercom, Zendesk, SQS, PHP.

CRURATED — PHP Software Developer, concurrent part-time subcontract | August 2024 – January 2026

- Took technical ownership of the production DataLake and event analytics system that supports product reporting and business insight.
- Designed versioned event publication for production use, improving consistency as new event types were integrated.

- Delivered production authentication, account linking and purchase-ownership verification for the Crutrade integration.

Technologies: PHP, EventBridge, S3, queues, webhooks.

airSlate — Technical Lead / Software Developer | February 2021 – August 2023

- Reduced peak load on the main database by removing bottlenecks and redistributing work, improving stability during high-traffic periods.
- Implemented deployment pipelines that shortened release cycles and improved consistency across backend services.
- Directed backend performance work that reduced API response times, using Prometheus to assess the result with the team.
- Led backend delivery planning and tracked team performance metrics to improve the pace of feature releases.

Technologies: PHP, Laravel, MySQL, RabbitMQ, AWS, Prometheus, GitHub Actions, ArgoCD.

Hyprr — Technical Lead | November 2019 – January 2021

- Helped bring a blockchain-based creator platform from prototype to closed beta while leading backend development.
- Defined the technology roadmap with the CTO and established the core stack for product delivery.

Technologies: PHP, Go, Laravel, MySQL, AWS, Ethereum.

Sixt — Senior Software Developer | December 2018 – November 2019

- Developed microservices to support GDPR compliance across the mobility platform.
- Enhanced application code under PCI DSS requirements, helping maintain security standards for payment-related systems.

Technologies: Microservices, GDPR, PCI DSS.

PDFfiller.com — Software Developer / Technical Lead | October 2016 – November 2019

Education

MSc in Computer Science, National Technical University, Kharkiv, Ukraine.

Languages

Ukrainian — native | English — professional working proficiency